

Sales Training — Session 34

Explain Like They're Seven.

The Librarian Pitch.

Tuesday 16 June 2026 · Marketing Sweet

WHAT THIS SESSION IS What to say when the buyer says "I don't understand any of this SEO stuff." Not a defence. Not a pitch. A one-minute story that turns confusion into a quiet "oh, I get it now" — and a research offer that books the next meeting.

1. The objection — "I don't understand any of this"

Most reps meet this objection within the first two minutes of a tradie call. "I don't know anything about marketing. I don't know how it works. I just don't want to mess with something I don't understand." The line lands as a refusal — and most reps respond as if it is one, either retreating or piling on more technical detail. Both responses lose the call.

What the buyer is actually saying is closer to: "I can't evaluate what you're offering me, so I'm not safe in this conversation." The objection isn't rejection — it's a confession that the rep hasn't yet given the buyer a way to make sense of what's being offered. The rep's job is to provide the sense-making in a way the buyer can accept without losing face.

"They're not refusing. They're telling you they don't have a frame for what you're saying. Give them the frame in a single sentence — then watch the conversation open up."

2. "Perfect — that's my job" — disarm in three words

Before the explanation comes the disarming move. When the buyer says "I don't understand it," the rep's first words are: "Perfect — that's exactly my job." The line works in three ways at once. It removes any shame the buyer might feel about admitting confusion. It positions the rep as a guide rather than a vendor. And it implicitly promises that the rep will make the next sentence make sense — buying the rep the buyer's full attention for the explanation that follows.

"I don't understand it." "Perfect — that's my job. Let me give you the picture, and you'll never need to think about it again."

The opposite move — defending, justifying, pitching technical detail — confirms the buyer's suspicion that the call will be hard work. Three words and a smile reset the tone of the entire conversation. Reps should practise this out loud until the reply lands automatically, every time.

3. The Einstein principle — if you can't explain it to a seven-year-old

The discipline beneath the librarian story. Einstein's famous claim: if you can't explain it to a seven-year-old, you don't understand it yourself. The rep should hold this as a personal litmus test. If the rep can only explain SEO using words like "crawler," "indexation," "domain authority," and "meta description" — they don't actually understand SEO well enough to sell it. Real understanding produces simple language. Pretend understanding produces jargon.

Practical move: every rep should be able to deliver the librarian explanation (below) cold, in 45 seconds, without notes. If they can't, that's the gap to close — not more product knowledge, just simpler language for the knowledge they already have.

"If you can't explain it to a seven-year-old, you don't understand it yourself. Sell what you understand. Simplify until you do."

4. The librarian pitch — the explanation, verbatim

The story Corie offered, word-for-word, for when the buyer says they don't understand SEO:

"Let me give you the picture. Every website on the internet is a book, and all those books sit in a library. The library is called Google — and Google is also the librarian. When someone types 'plumber near me' into Google, the librarian has to go and grab the right book off the shelf. The problem is, there are ten million books that could be the right one — so she picks the ten she thinks are the best match. Those are the websites that show up on page one. My job is to make sure your book is one of the ten she picks."

Why it works. The story uses three concrete objects — book, library, librarian — that the buyer can hold in their head while the rep keeps talking. The mental model carries through the rest of the call. When the rep later mentions "ranking," the buyer doesn't think technical — they think "which ten books the librarian picked." When the rep mentions "competition," the buyer thinks "the other books on the same shelf." The librarian becomes the operating metaphor for everything the rep says afterwards.

Three reps in the session pointed out the same effect: once they used the librarian explanation, the buyer stopped asking technical clarifying questions. They had a model. They were ready to listen. Most importantly: the buyer felt smart for understanding, not stupid for asking — and the rep had earned the right to keep going.

5. Two SEO levers — authority and relevancy

Once the librarian frame is in place, the rep can explain the two things the agency actually does without losing the buyer. There are only two main levers in SEO — call them authority and relevancy. Everything else is a sub-category.

Authority — the JK Rowling principle. If JK Rowling writes a book, the librarian is more likely to pick it because she trusts the author. Backlinks from credible sites work the same way for websites. The rep's job is to get respected authors (sites) to mention the buyer's book (site), which increases the librarian's confidence in picking it. "That's what backlinking is — borrowing JK Rowling's reputation for your book."

Relevancy — the content match. If a buyer types "emergency plumber Adelaide" and the book on the shelf is mostly about commercial plumbing in Melbourne, the librarian won't pick it — it doesn't match the search. The rep's job is to make sure the content on the buyer's site actually matches what their ideal customer is searching for. "That's what content optimisation is — making sure your book is about the things people are actually asking the librarian for."

"Two main levers — authority and relevancy. Everything else fits underneath those two. Don't go technical past that point — you'll lose them."

6. The research offer — "low-hanging fruit"

The booking move, used once the librarian frame is in place. The rep doesn't try to close the deal on the call. They close the next meeting — and they do it with a soft, specific offer. "I'd like 30 minutes to look at your site and find the low-hanging fruit. Then I'd like five or ten minutes of your time to walk you through what I found. Sound fair?"

Three deliberate choices in that line. "Low-hanging fruit" — a phrase tradies use themselves, which makes the offer sound practical rather than theoretical. "30 minutes to look" — the rep is doing the work upfront; the buyer is risking nothing. "Five or ten minutes" — the same currency frame from earlier sessions; small ask, easy to grant.

"My research takes me about half an hour. Then I'd like 5–10 minutes with you to show you what I found. Want me to take a look?"

During that 30 minutes of research, the rep does three things: identifies the buyer's strongest service page (e.g. "emergency plumbing"), checks their ranking position for the most-valuable keyword pairing (service + suburb), and prepares one screenshot of what the buyer is missing. The follow-up meeting is short, visual, and specific — which is exactly the shape that books deals at the agency.

7. Power words — what they are and how they land

A power word is any word that carries more emotional weight than its plain alternative — "perfect" instead of "okay," "opportunity" instead of "thing," "low-hanging fruit" instead of "easy stuff." Used sparingly and sincerely, power words pull the buyer's attention up. Used carelessly, they sound rehearsed. The difference is whether the rep believes what they're saying when the word comes out.

Examples from the session, by category:

- Strength: perfect, guaranteed, absolutely, fantastic, amazing, incredible, definitely, certainly, second to none, sincerely, obsessed.
- Intelligence: sophisticated, methodical, meticulous, persistent, state of the art, opportunity, projections, research.

- Warmth: grateful, appreciate, resonate, helpful, friendly, ongoing support, transparent, intention.

The list isn't to be memorised. Each rep should pick five or six that genuinely resonate for them — words that feel true coming out of their mouth — and weave those into their natural pitch. The list goes on the wall (Session 31's wall, extended) so the team adds to it as they discover new ones in live calls.

8. Tonality — baseline plus lift

The other half of the power word equation. A power word delivered flatly is just a word. The same word with the right tonal lift behind it is the move. Corie's framing: every rep has a vocal baseline — their natural conversational tone. The job isn't to abandon the baseline. It's to use the baseline as the floor, lift for one or two key words per sentence, then return to the baseline.

Two failure modes to avoid. The flatliner — speaks every word at the same level. Sounds disengaged and the power words land as noise. The faker — pushes every word up to maximum enthusiasm, creating a new flat line at the top. Sounds rehearsed and oddly desperate. The buyer can sense both, instantly.

"You need a baseline. Then you lift. Then you come back. The lift is where the power words live. Everything else is the runway."

Practical drill: pick three sentences from a recent live call. Read them flat. Then read them again, lifting one word per sentence — the highest-value word — and noticing the shift in energy. Practise this until the lift is automatic. Most reps need 10 minutes of conscious practice to internalise it, and then it never goes away.

9. Action items for the team

1. Memorise the librarian explanation verbatim. Practise it cold, in under 45 seconds, until it lands like a casual story.
2. Replace any technical word — "crawler," "indexation," "meta" — with a librarian-frame word in every prospect call this week.
3. Memorise the two levers explanation. Authority = JK Rowling. Relevancy = content match. Nothing more technical than that.
4. Use the "low-hanging fruit" research offer on every call where the buyer shows even mild interest. 30 minutes upfront. 5–10 minutes to present.
5. Pick 5–6 power words from the list this week. Pick ones that feel TRUE coming out of your mouth — not the ones that sound coolest.
6. Move the power words list out of Felipe's office and onto the main wall. Every desk should see it. Add to it weekly.

7. Practise the tonality drill: one lifted word per sentence, return to baseline. Ten minutes is enough to internalise it.

THE RULE OF THUMB If they can't picture it, they can't buy it. Give them the librarian. Give them the two levers. Give them the low-hanging fruit. Then book the meeting and stop talking.